12. There is no political democracy in Turkey -- despite democracy of manners and a comparative equality of social conditions. The members of Turkey's National Assembly are elected from nominees approved by the President of the Republic. Turkey is, in fact, a party dictatorship.

Economic backwardness is only beginning to be overcome despite extensive State economic initiative. In 1935 fully 80 percent of Turkey's gainfully employed were occupied in agriculture and stock-raising, only 8 percent in industry, handicrafts, mining, and construction. In 1937-39 less than 3 percent of Turkey's exports consisted of manufactures, while 65 percent of her imports were manufactures. She was particularly dependent on Germany, which supplied 47 percent of her imports and took 39 percent of her exports. She could not manufacture her own heavy armament.

This economic backwardness largely explains the unheroic role that Turkey played in World War II. She accepted all the aid she could get from both sides while remaining neutral to the last moment. She received shipments of gold and armaments from the United Nations and sold chromium and grains to Germany.

A similarly unheroic role in World War II has been played by the second great State of the Middle East, Egypt. On June 13, 1940, shortly after Italy entered the war, the Egyptian Prime Minister announced that Egypt would fight "... if Italian troops entered Egyptian territory; if Egyptian towns are bombed by Italian aircraft; if Egyptian military objectives are bombed." Parliament acclaimed these pronouncements demonstratively. But no one took them seriously. All these ifs were realized. Italian (and German) troops entered Egyptian territory. Bombs fell on Alexandria, Cairo, and Suez. Egyptian governments came and went. But Egypt did not fight. Her governments merely became more cautious. If Italy and Germany were going to be the victors, Egypt must be in a position to argue that she had shown them at least a benevolent neutrality. So Egypt did not declare war in 1940 or 1941 or 1942 or 1943 or 1944. She declared war in 1945! And then the declaration of war was opposed by the "popular" Wafd party.